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Screaming Timmy Must Die

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SCREAMING TIMMY MUST DIE

By Steve DuBois

CAST OF CHARACTERS

CALVIN: An evil eight-year-old. Has an extensive vocabulary.

DENNIS: An evil eight-year-old. Has a nervous disorder.

NANCY: An evil eight-year-old. Has a talent for plotting and a taste for dangerous men.

TIMMY: An evil eight-year-old. Has the loudest and most annoying voice in human history.

SPLODEY JOE: An evil eight-year-old the size of an NFL linebacker. Has the ability to make people explode by pointing at them.

GEORGE: An evil eight-year-old. Has a toy truck.

SALLY: An evil eight-year-old. Has no lines.

MISS WATKINS: An elementary school student teacher. Has had it with these little bastards.

WOLVERINE: A small mammal of no particular moral alignment. Has a brain injury.

#

[Morning recess at Mephisto Elementary School. Calvin and Dennis sit atop the monkey bars, staring down at the antics of their classmates.]

CALVIN: Screaming Timmy *must* die. His nefarious tactics can no longer be borne.

DENNIS: Indeed, friend Calvin! The death of Screaming Timmy is much to be desired!

CALVIN: Even here at Mephisto Elementary School, the nation's premier academy for pre-pubescent supervillains-in-training, Screaming Timmy's loathsome ways stand out. I tell you, Dennis, I despise his smug little face! His brown-nosing! That stupid little sailor suit he always wears! How I long to wrap my fingers 'round his pudgy little windpipe and *squeeze!*

DENNIS: Behold! Over by the sandbox! Even now, he prepares one of his vile ambuscades!

[GEORGE sits in the sandbox, playing with a small toy truck. TIMMY appears behind him.]

TIMMY: Whassat? Whassat you got there George?

[George tries to hide the truck.]

TIMMY: Whassat object George? Whassat object gimmee object I wanna object WHASSAT OBJECT…

[Timmy's voice transforms into a piercing, obnoxious shriek.]

TIMMY: GIMMEEITIWANNITGIMMEEOBJECTGIMMEE**GIMMMEEEEEEEEE**….

[George covers his ears in agony and pushes the toy truck over towards Timmy. Timmy picks it up, glances at it idly, places it on the ground, and stomps on it. Then he picks it up, hands it back to George, smiles, and skips away happily. George looks down at the remains of his toy, crying quietly.]

CALVIN: George 'The Ram' Ramirez, a young supervillain of exceptional power and potential. Yet confronted with the tactics of Screaming Timmy, he is helpless as a kitten.

DENNIS: It is obscene! Action must be taken!

CALVIN: Yes. Yes, there can be no question. Screaming Timmy must die.

#

[Introduction here.]

#

[NANCY enters, climbing up the monkey bars to sit beside Calvin and Dennis.]

NANCY: And what is this? A confederacy, I think. I smell a scheme upon the November wind. A scheme that would rid us all of that most pestilential presence, Screaming Timmy.

CALVIN: What? Nancy? Why…er no! Never! Nothing of the sort! Screaming Timmy is…a beloved friend!

DENNIS: Um…yes! A friend to all is screaming Timmy!

CALVIN: We are in no way troubled by the scent of mayonnaise that follows him everywhere in a reeking cloud!

DENNIS: Why, his window-shattering shrieks are as birdsong to us!

CALVIN: We were merely discussing…um…boy things!

DENNIS: Yes! The performance of…of a local sports franchise!

CALVIN: The salting of slugs. The operation of internal combustion engines. Items of that nature.

NANCY: A futile ruse, gentlemen. The truth is writ bold upon your faces. The demise of Screaming Timmy is indeed your design. But fear not; I shall not reveal your conspiracy. Rather, I wish to join it.

Not one week hence, Screaming Timmy tore the head from my beloved dolly. It is war, war to the last, between Screaming Timmy and I.

[Calvin and Dennis glance at each other and reach an unspoken agreement.]

CALVIN: Very well. The three of us—co-conspirators, bound in blood.

DENNIS: No additional recruits, mind you! One word in the wrong ear, and we are undone!

NANCY: I know not why. Who is to object? Mephisto Elementary has an annual fatality rate of nearly forty percent. Many enter into these hallowed halls, but few indeed are those who survive to graduate. Observe. Why, look…even now, by the tetherball poles, the custodial staff gathers the smoldering remains of Fiendish Franklin Flash into numerous small sandwich bags.

CALVIN: Still, it is essentially not to draw the attention of outside authorities to the Mephisto project. To do so is to risk a trip…to the Principal's Office.

[All three of them shudder.]

NANCY: Stealthily, then. To class, my boys. And be watchful for opportunities…

#

[CALVIN, DENNIS, and NANCY are gathered inside the school door leading out to the playground. A huge pile of educational bric-a-brac is perched above the door.]

CALVIN: Behold our wonder of engineering! A towering, teetering pile of desks, folding chairs, school supplies, spent nuclear waste, playground equipment, and janitorial supplies, all held in place above the playground door by a single duct-taped mop handle!

DENNIS: A most impressive edifice!

CALVIN: Why, is that a lightly stunned wolverine amidst the wreckage?

WOLVERINE: *[Chitters menacingly]*

CALVIN: Indeed! And now this incipient avalanche waits, dangling like a proverbial Sword of Damocles above the unsuspecting head of the odious Screaming Timmy. A tip of the cap to you, respected friend Nancy, on your most cunning scheme.

NANCY: It is a well-established fact that Screaming Timmy insists on being first in every line, including the line to come in from recess. And that shall be his undoing. For when he comes through the door, and dislodges the prop…

DENNIS: Screaming Timmy's time grows short! Soon his screams shall resound in hell!

CALVIN: But soft, friends! To the window. I hear the clanging of the recess bell. The fateful moment approaches…

[Outside, MISS WATKINS, an overwhelmed student teacher, struggles vainly to shepherd the evil children back inside.]

WATKINS: All right, children, everybody line up by—BOBBY! PUT THAT CHAINSAW DOWN!—line up by grade! No, *straight* lines, please. Yes, Samantha, I know that space-time is technically curved, but I still need you to…

TIMMY: More recess!

WATKINS: Now, Screaming Timmy, you know that's not how it works. The bell rings, and we all march back inside. March, march, march. You've got social studies next. Won't that be fun? You'll get to show everybody that Vlad the Impaler diorama you've been—

TIMMY: More recess! WANNA MORE RECESS!

WATKINS: No, now, Screaming Timmy, we talked about this, please, just don't…

TIMMY: **WANNARECESSWANNAMORERECESSAIEEEEEEEEEEEEE…**

WATKINS: *[Covering her ears]* All right! All right! Yes, you can have more recess! More recess for everybody!

TIMMY: No! Just Timmy! More recess for TIMMY!

WATKINS: All right, Screaming Timmy. Just don't scream, all right? Just you. Recess for nobody else but you. Everybody else, back in your lines. Hold on, I have to go inside and find somebody to supervise Screaming Timmy. I think this is Mr. Okoye's plan period…

CALVIN: *[In a whisper]* No! No! This was not the plan!

WATKINS: *[Walking back inside, under her breath.]* God, that little turd. This whole school! Who ARE these people? I wonder if that bartending job's still available…oh, Christ, now the door's blocked. NGGGH! There, that's got it…AAAAAAAAAH!

[She looks up and screams as the avalanche of debris descends on her, squashing her to pulp. Inside, the three conspirators watch in horror.]

DENNIS: Alas! The lovely Miss Watkins!

CALVIN: *[to Nancy]* This is your fault, you trollop! Your scheme is an abject failure!

NANCY: Me? Who was it that insisted that we delay construction for two days in order for the depleted uranium to arrive? You've made a hash of everything, you buffoon!

[Calvin and Nancy lock gazes, snarling menacingly at one another]

DENNIS: Comrades! Do not lose sight of the true enemy! Screaming Timmy breathes yet!

CALVIN: Very well. Let us set aside our differences.

NANCY: Acceptable. For the present.

CALVIN: We shall redirect our anger, and redouble our efforts. The next time Screaming Timmy screams, we three shall be the reason.

#

[The playground. Calvin and Dennis stand in a small alcove.]

CALVIN: Where is Nancy? It is unlike our colleague to be late, and she promised us a surprise.

DENNIS: There! She approaches!

CALVIN: But…who is that hulking figure behind her? The one being dragged by the hand, like an ocean liner behind a tugboat? His description matches that of…but…surely not. It cannot be.

NANCY: Gentlemen. *[She proudly gestures to the immense boy whose hand she is holding.]* I wish to introduce the newest, and most powerful, piece in our game.

CALVIN: Impossible. He is a myth, surely?

DENNIS: Inconceivable! It is said that they keep him in the basement! Inside a vault! Under guard! Strapped to a gurney!

NANCY: Such obstacles are nothing to a girl of cunning and initiative. And what locked door can hold true love inside? It is indeed he. I present to you, my boyfriend…Splodey Joe.

[Splodey Joe stares straight ahead, slackjawed.]

JOE: Nggggggggggffff.

CALVIN: A…a demonstration, Splodey Joe! A mere taste of your fabled power! We beseech you!

DENNIS: An aperitif, as it were! To whet our appetites for the feast of carnage to come!

[Splodey Joe notices them for the first time, and grunts his assent. In the distance, SALLY babbles aimlessly, gossiping with a group of her friends. Splodey Joe slowly raises his arm and points his finger at her. Sally stops talking, clutches herself in momentary discomfort, and then explodes, showering her friends with red mist. Calvin and Dennis gaze in awe.]

CALVIN: Behold the astonishing talents of Splodey Joe!

DENNIS: I renounce all other Gods! Henceforth I worship only Splodey Joe!

[Nancy sighs adoringly and gazes moonily up at Splodey Joe. He stares straight ahead, not noticing.]

CALVIN: It seems that our femme fatale has a crush on our secret weapon.

DENNIS: As do I!

CALVIN: Wait a moment. Do you… *[he sniffs]* Do you smell mayonnaise?

[Screaming Timmy appears.]

TIMMY: Hey! Hey, new kid! Be my friend!

DENNIS: Ecce homo! Behold the man!

CALVIN: Our quarry! Attend, Splodey Joe! There stands your target!

JOE: *[Cocking his head to the side in confusion]* Grrrrgh?

NANCY: Tee-hee! How amusingly droll you are, Splodey Joe!

TIMMY: I got no friends! Wanna friend! Be my friend, new kid!

CALVIN: Do no such thing! Gaze upon your death, Screaming Timmy!

DENNIS: Strike now, Splodey Joe! The time is ripe!

JOE: *[Glances back and forth between the four of them in total bewilderment.]* Mwrrf?

TIMMY: Gotnofriendsbemyfriendwannafriend WANNAFRIEND**BEMYFRIEND**

JOE: *[Places his hands over his ears, groaning in pain.]*

CALVIN: Be not deterred, Splodey Joe! End your pain, and ours!

DENNIS: Obliterate him, Splodey Joe!

TIMMY: **WANNAFRIENDBEFRIENDWANNAFRIENDBEFRIENDWANNAFRIEND**

[Clutching his ears in agony, his eyes uncomprehending, Joe raises his finger to point at Timmy, then at Calvin, then at Dennis, then at Nancy, then back at Timmy. Finally, he points his finger at himself. There is a massive explosion. When the debris clears, all five of the other children are drenched in red mist.]

NANCY: *[Stares down the remains of Joe all over herself, then throws back her head to the sky.]* NOOOOOOOOOOOOOOO! SPLODEY JOE!

TIMMY: *[Wipes a palm across his face, stares at it for a moment, then licks it and smiles.]* Thanks, friend! *[He skips away merrily.]*

DENNIS: A substantial setback!

CALVIN: *[Pulls out his shirttail, cleans his glasses on it. Struggles for words. Finally manages:]* O infamy.

#

[Calvin, Dennis, and Nancy are gathered on the roof of the school, overlooking a drop to the blacktop below.]

CALVIN: I gather you together for the final time, my comrades. From up here on the school roof, we can see far—and one of the things we must gaze up on stark reality. None can stand against the machinations of Screaming Timmy. The day is his.

DENNIS: Pish and tosh! Why, there are stratagems yet unexplored! Retroviral engineering! Giant robots! Spitwads!

CALVIN: Nay. Against a lesser opponent, such schemes might prevail. But not against the all-conquering tactical juggernaut that is Screaming Timmy. In any case, we have no-one capable of designing the blueprint for any such scheme. Our master planner has been rendered nearly catatonic by her tragic loss.

NANCY: *[Staring morosely into the distance.]* Farewell, my sweet. Farewell forever, Splodey Joe. *[She pulls out a juice box, and inserts a straw.]* A last libation for our lost love. *[She pours out the juice box onto the roof]*.

CALVIN: So this must conclude our partnership, I fear. It was a worthy and noble effort, but we have failed to… *[he sniffs the air]* …wait a minute…

[Screaming Timmy appears.]

TIMMY: Hey! Why you guys up here on the roof? Shouldn' be up here! I'm tellin' the teacher! I'm tellin' the PRINCIPAL!

DENNIS: Scalawag! Mountebank! Most despised Screaming Timmy!

CALVIN: Wretched boy! Is there no avoiding you? Is there nowhere we can go to be relieved of your insufferable presence, you ever-present kidney stone in our collective urethra?

TIMMY: [Frowning] Why you guys talk that way? You always talk that way. All threea you. All those big words. Shouldn' talk that way. Gives me a headache.

[A long pause. Slowly, Nancy rises from her seat overlooking the blacktop.]

NANCY: Oh, it does, does it?

TIMMY: Yeah! Long words. Weird words. Don' like 'em.

CALVIN: Why, Screaming Timmy. Did you never wonder at our presence, here at Mephisto? Did you never ask yourself why we three, with no evident powers, would be placed at this special institution for genetically gifted avatars of evil? Know then, Screaming Timmy, that our specific gift, the skill with which we shall conquer the world, is *monologuing.*

NANCY: Monologuing and scheming!

DENNIS: Monologuing and scheming and general twitchiness!

TIMMY: Yeah…well…you stop. Don' like it.

CALVIN: Oh, I think not. I THINK NOT, SCREAMING TIMMY! I think our monologuing, our vocabularial manipulations and meanderings, shall be GREATLY ENHANCED henceforth! For no simpering delinquent such as yourself can still the tongue of the illustrious Calvin Cruel!

TIMMY: Shut up! Shut up, meanies!

DENNIS: Never! Dread the dolorous dictations of Menacing Dennis!

TIMMY: Shut up! *[He begins racing around the roof in circles, eyes shut and hands over his ears.]* **SHUTUPSHUTUPSHUTUP!**

NANCY: Shudder, malignant twerp-turd, at the loquacious lexicon of Nancy Grue!

TIMMY: **BADWORDSMEANWORDSSHUTUPSHUTUUUUUUUUUU….**

[Eyes still shut, Timmy races straight off the edge of the roof, and plummets to the blacktop below. The three conspirators stare down after him.]

CALVIN: Thus ends the contemptible reign of Screaming Timmy.

DENNIS: Sic semper screamers!

NANCY: I feel we have learned a valuable lesson today. Even in the face of seemingly insurmountable obstacles, a boy or a girl can succeed. All that is required is teamwork, belief in one's self, and a complete disregard for human life.

CALVIN: And perhaps a thesaurus.

DENNIS: Seventh period next. Arts and crafts!

CALVIN: Excellent. To the classroom, my friends! I feel a powerful hunger for paste.